

already know that wedges underperform, so this is another statistic that confirms that poor performance.

[Table 73.3](#) shows failure rates for falling wedges. The best performance (fewest breakeven failures) comes from wedges in bear markets with upward breakouts (which is odd because it's a countertrend move). Even so, 24% of wedges failed to see price rise more than 5%. Notice how small the sample counts are. *Hmm*. Maybe that explains the lower failure rate.

Here's another example: 38% of wedges failed to see price rise more than 10%. Notice that at this level, bull markets have a slightly smaller failure rate, 37%. The two columns argue over which has the lower failure rate as you scan down the list. Bull markets with upward breakouts eventually win, though.

Here's how to use this table. Suppose you find a falling wedge that peaks at 15 and spirals down to 10, where price breaks out upward in bull markets. Since the measure rule says to expect a climb back up to the top of the wedge, what are the chances of that happening?

A climb from 10 to 15 is 50%, and the table shows that 76% fail to climb above that. Thus, the measure rule is too optimistic, and price is unlikely to reach the top of the pattern before tumbling more than 20%.